

Observations

I compiled a sheet of my findings while on my site visit in Echo Park. The sheet consists of photos, textures, and sketches.

Synthesis

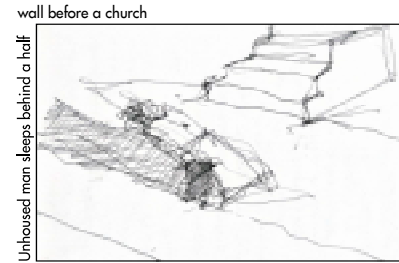
My synthesis drawing consists of analyzing different views of the site. Different programs are depicted in different colors where the concentration between corporate and small businesses is highlighted. The drawing also aims to show the concentration of churches, housing, and government buildings as well through a 3D model in contrast to the typical 2D drawing.

OBSERVATIONS IN THE CITY OF ANGELS

1911 SUNSET BLVD. AND EXTENDED AREA



Hard edge between abandoned building and empty site



wall before a church
Unhoused man sleeps behind a wall



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Perspective in front of Richard Neutra's VDL House. Showing a blend between organic and the manmade.

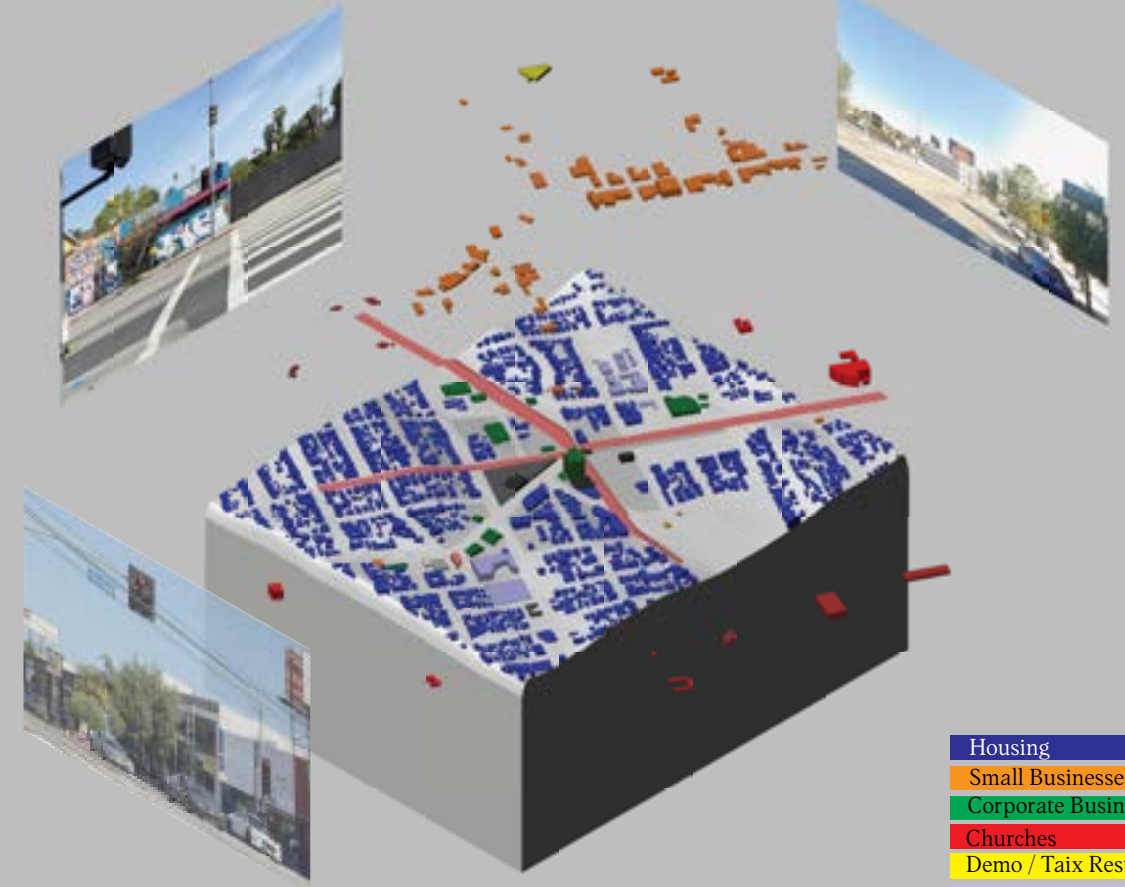


Habit and Chipotle across the street from 1911 Sunset Blvd

The site sits next to a library that tucks itself behind a series of trees. The entrance is obscured from across the street. There is no formal housing on the block as of this moment. A bridge formally divides the west and east sides of Echo Park, acting as a human desert formed by Glendale Blvd.



1911 Sunset Blvd., Los Angeles, California



- Housing
- Small Businesses
- Corporate Businesses
- Churches
- Demo / Taix Restaurant
- School
- Government

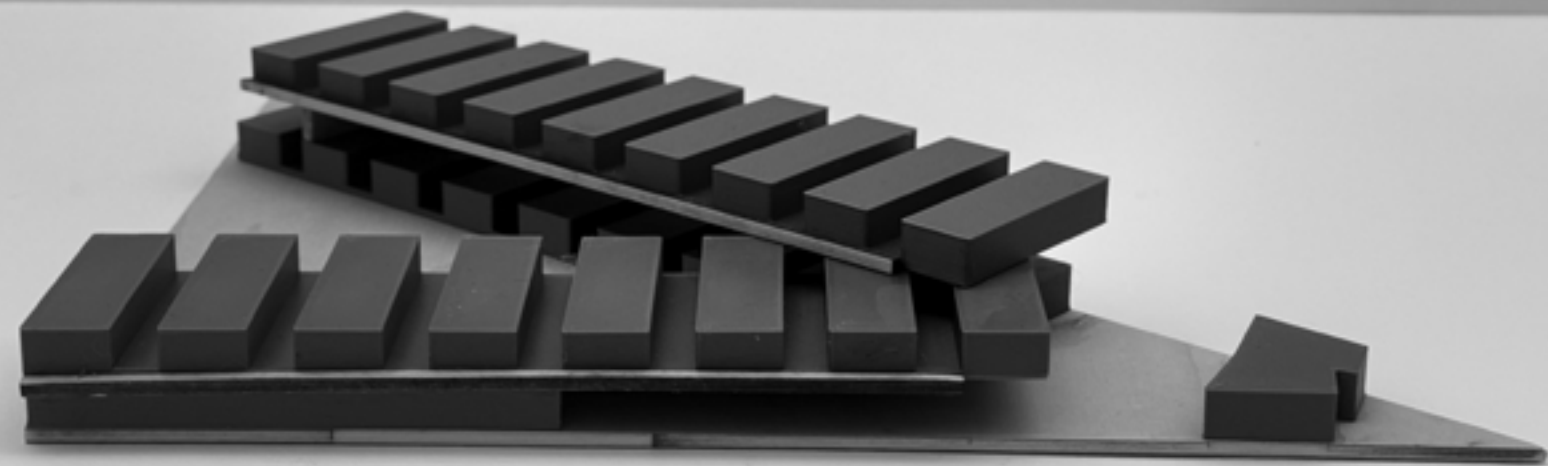
Josiah Mateo Alvarez
ARCH 253 | Studio Ford | Spring 2026

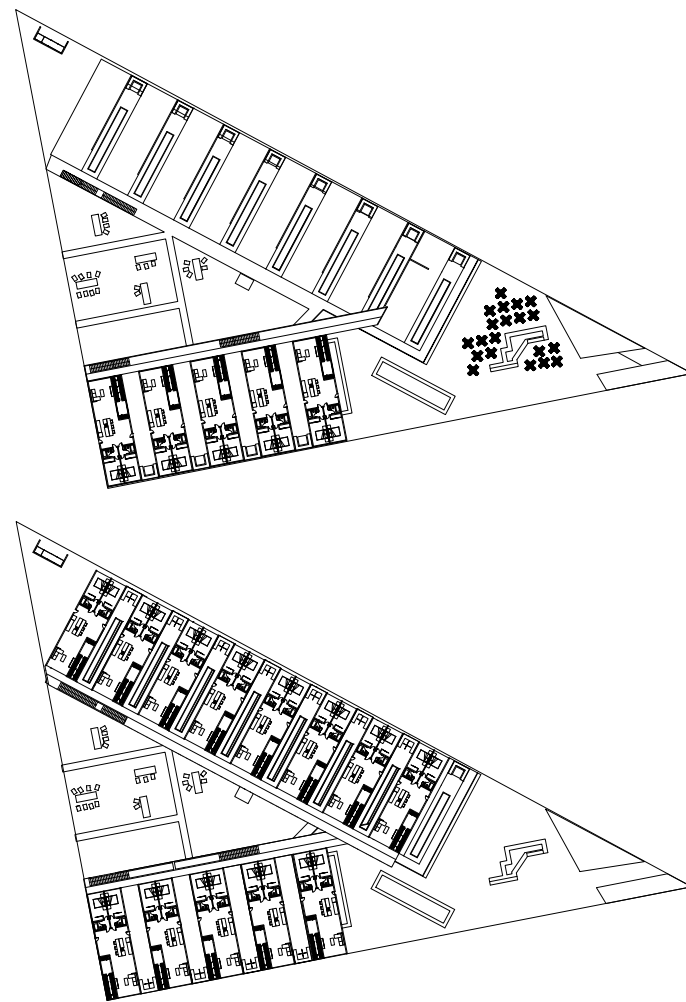
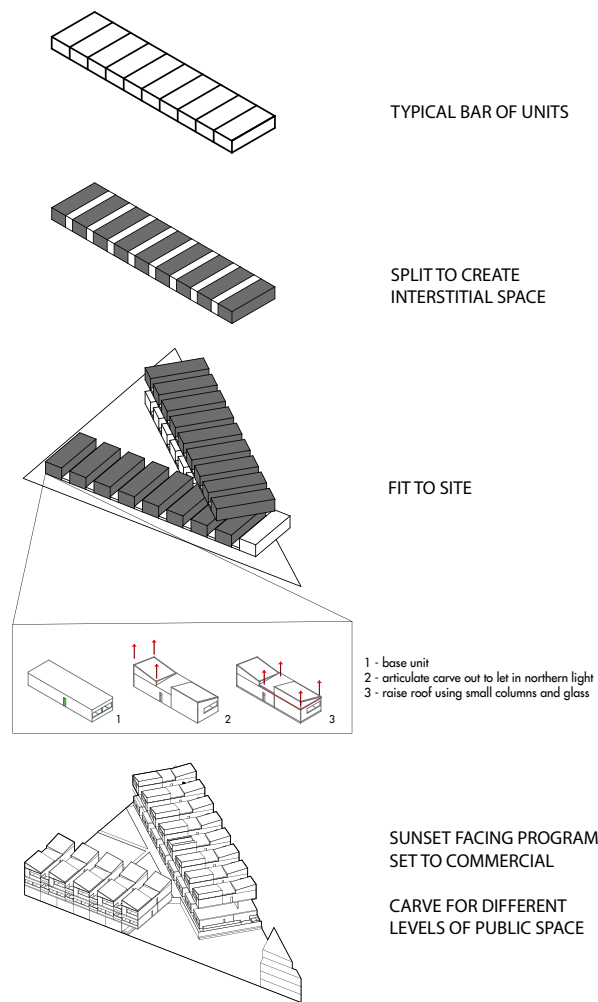
FINAL PROJECT: housing in echo park

SKILLS: Housing Design, Rhino 8, Illustrator, Twinmotion, Grasshopper, Photoshop

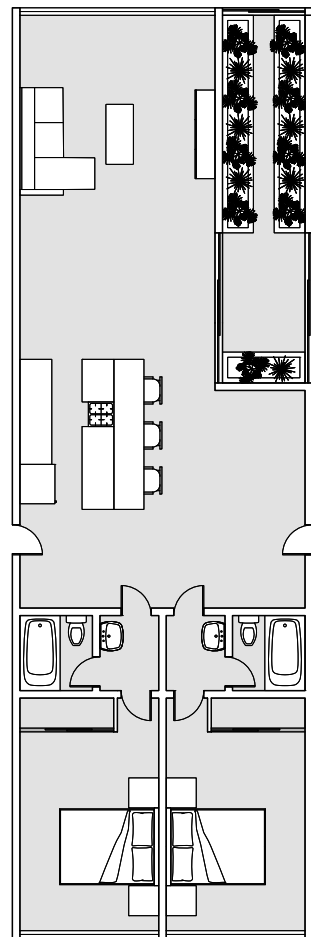
For the Final Project I had to synthesize site analysis, previous form studies, and precedents to create a housing project of 28-36 units on the site of 1911 Sunset Blvd. My project, columna collective housing, is a collective style housing project that creates interstitial space between units that is shared. This shared space is alive, liminal and yet tangible. There is multiple levels of outdoor space when it comes to privacy and scale for both residents of the project and Echo Park as a whole.

perspective view depicting parametric rail guard, typical units, and public plaza

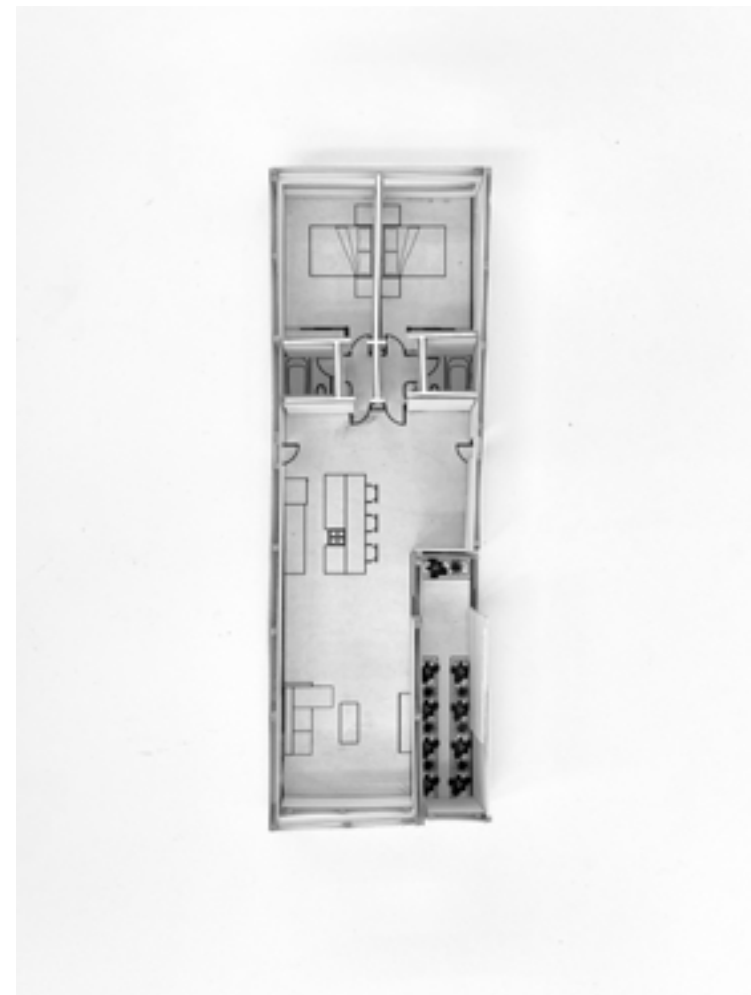
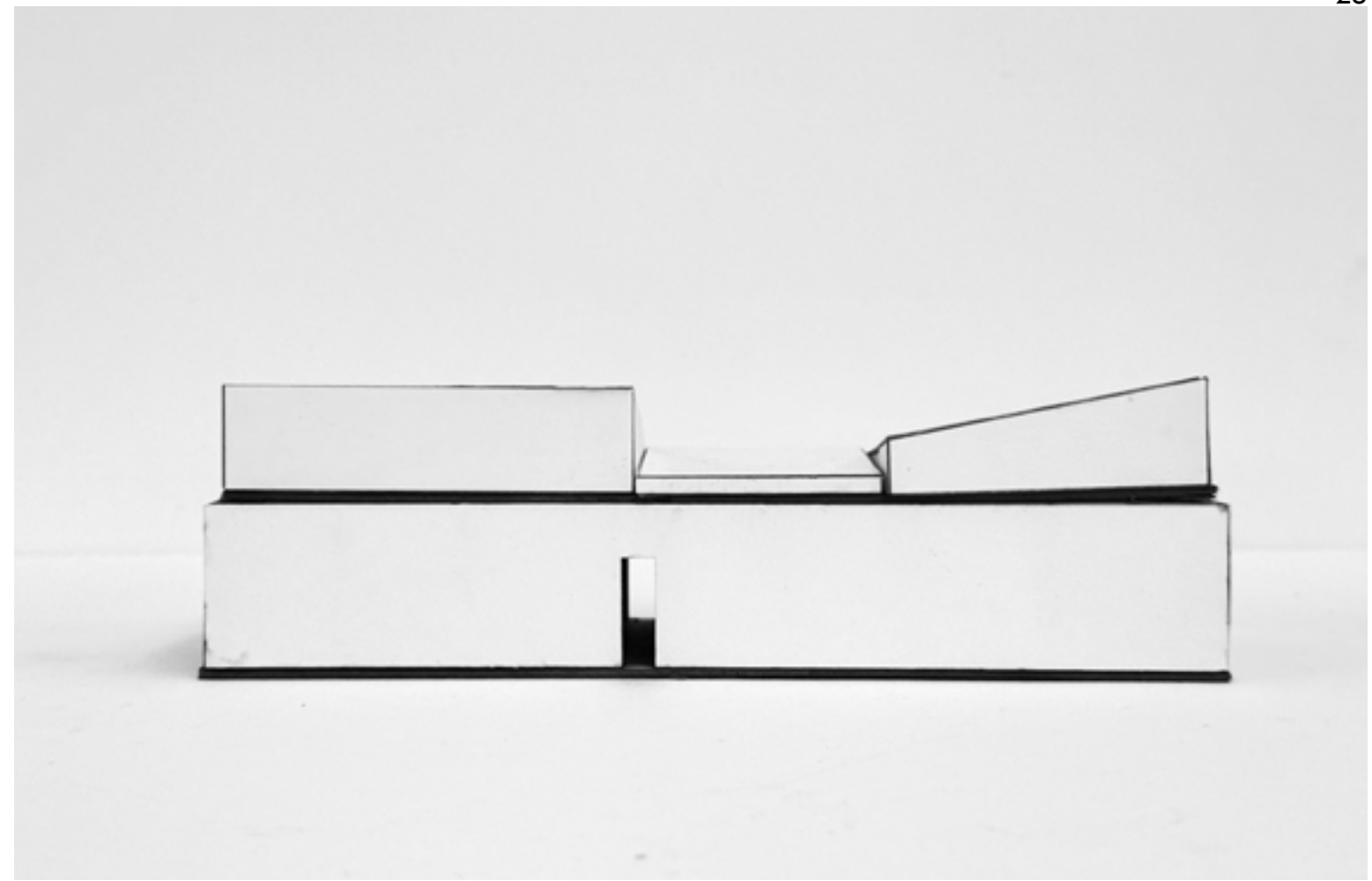
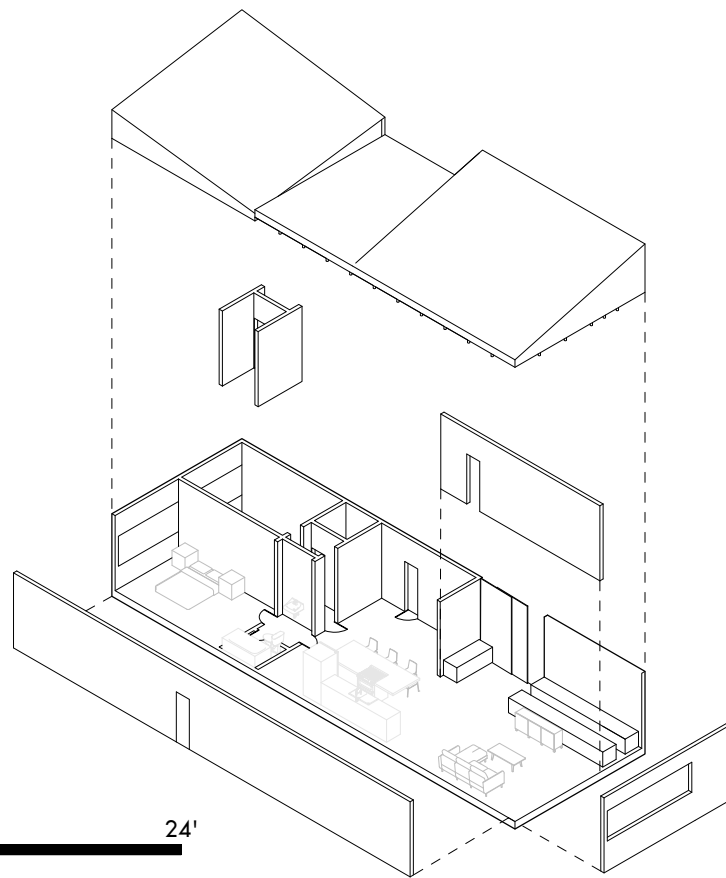




left to right: concept diagram, 2nd floor plan, 3rd floor plan, unit floor plan, unit isometric



8' 24'



unit model photos (1/8" = 1'0")

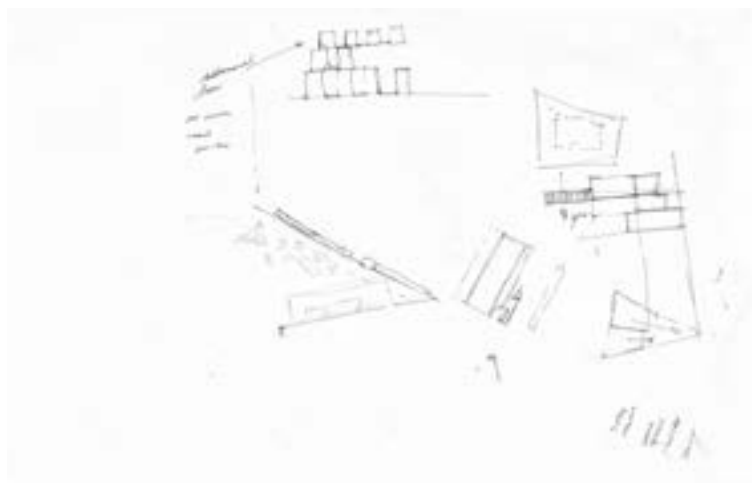
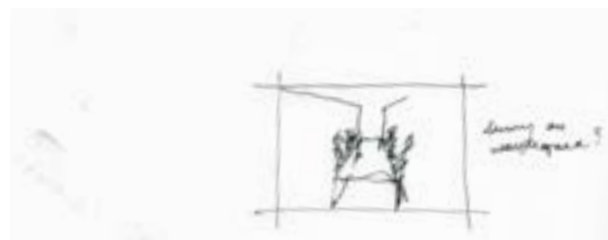
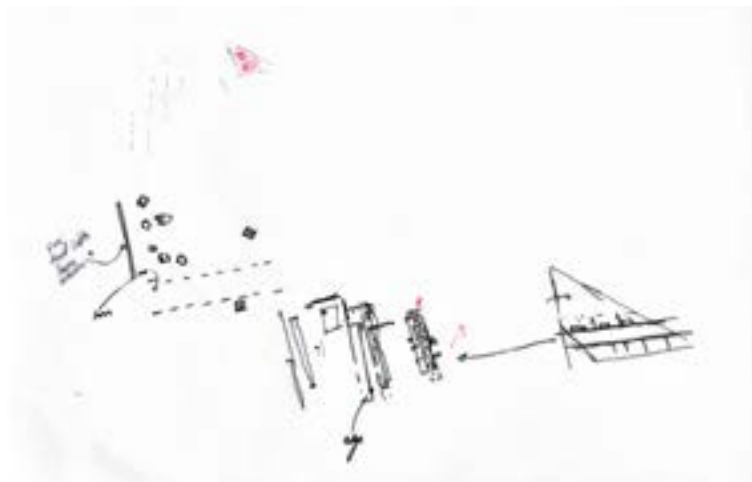
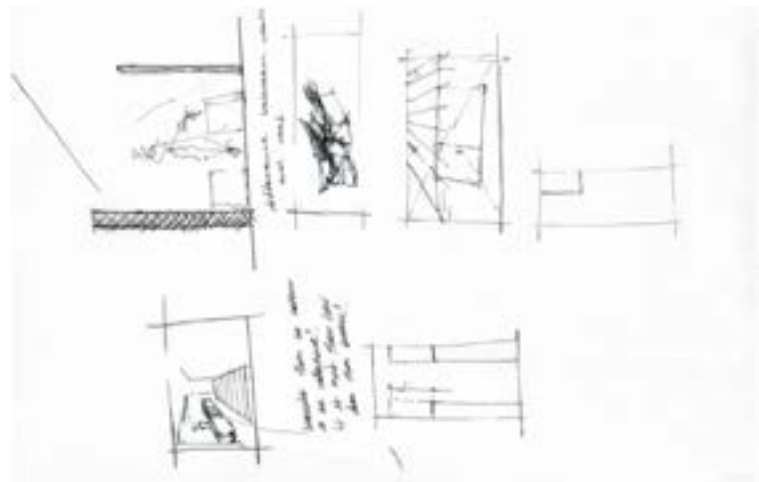
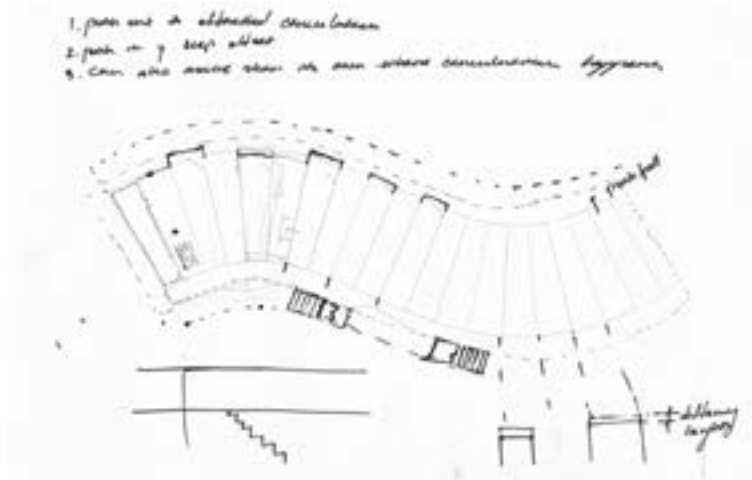
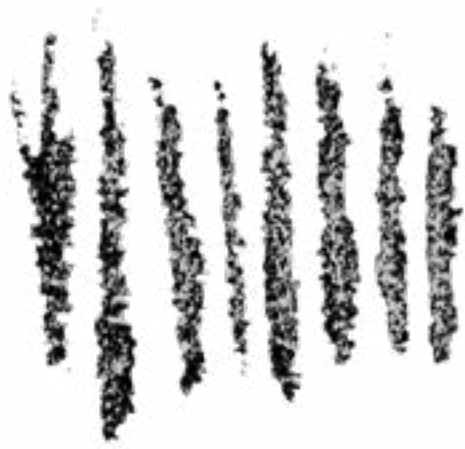


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process work and satellite site map

REFLECTION

This quarter has been a significant leap in both my software proficiency but also my design thinking. Developing these two in tandem is going to be crucial when it comes to tackling increasingly challenging projects in the future. As per every quarter, I hope to further my physical modeling skills while still using it as a tool to develop design. This quarter was largely also about choosing battles; which I might assume may be a pattern when it comes to future projects and professional practice. Housing as a typology is extremely meaningful to me, which I aimed to express that sentiment through the project. One thing that I hope to further improve is my ability to translate initial sketches and concepts to tangible deliverables for lack of a better word. The softness of the edge that is seen in the initial collage was largely not captured in the way that I would have done so today. Additionally, the clarity of the drawings can always be improved as that is their main purpose, to communicate. Overall, this quarter was largely a step in the right direction as I hope to fill in the gaps in future quarters and months.